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PREFACE

The annual Harvard Celtic Colloquium has its origins in a Graduate Student conference established in 1980 by students at Harvard University's Department of Celtic Languages and Literatures. While it is still the only conference in the field of Celtic Studies to be organized and run by graduate students, the Colloquium has gained an international reputation which annually draws a diverse mix of scholars (including graduate students, junior and senior academics, and unaffiliated scholars) to present papers on all facets of Celtic Studies.

Papers given at each Colloquium may be submitted for review, and a selection is edited by the organizers for publication in that year's *Proceedings of the Harvard Celtic Colloquium*. Information on all aspects of the Colloquium and the *Proceedings* (including subscription and back issues) may be obtained at www.fas.harvard.edu/~hcc. Dorothy Africa, the managing editor for PHCC, may be contacted directly at phcc@fas.harvard.edu.

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Evidence for Indo-European Acrostatic Presents in Old Irish?

Ryan Sandell

I. Introduction: McCone (1991) versus Matasović (2009)

The primary aim of this paper is to treat the phonological and morphological prehistory of three Old Irish present stems that defy easy reckoning: *ic* 'reaches', *ith-* 'eats' and *rig-* 'stretches; directs, rules'.¹ To re-evaluate the development of the Irish forms from Indo-European roots and inflection categories is necessary at this time, because their most accessible treatments, namely those of McCone² and Matasović,³ disagree sharply. McCone (1991), on the one hand, adduces *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* as crucial Celtic continuants of the Proto-Indo-European (PIE) "Narten"-type or ACROSTATIC present, as first identified by Narten.⁴ Matasović (2009), on the other hand,

¹ I employ the following abbreviations throughout: DIL = *Dictionary of the Irish Language*; LIV² = *Lexicon der Indogermanischen Verben*, 2nd ed.; NIL = *Nomina im Indogermanischen Lexicon*; Ved. = Vedic Sanskrit; RV = *R̥gveda*; AV = *Atharvaveda*; OAv. = Old Avestan; YAv. = Young Avestan; Grk. = Ancient Greek; Hom. = Homeric Greek; Lat. = Latin; Hitt. = Hittite; PCelt. = Proto-Celtic; OIr. = Old Irish; M̄Ir. = Middle Irish; MW = Middle Welsh; Gaul. = Gaulish; Goth. = Gothic; OE = Old English; OHG = Old High German; Lith. = Lithuanian; Latv. = Latvian; OCS = Old Church Slavonic. Sigla for Irish texts follow the DIL.

² Kim McCone, "OIr. *-ic* 'reaches', *ithid* 'eats' *rigid* 'stretches, directs, rules' and the PIE 'Narten,' Present in Celtic," in *Ériu* 42 (1991), pp. 1-11.

³ Ranko Matasović, *Etymological Dictionary of Proto-Celtic* (Leiden: Brill, 2009).

⁴ Johanna Narten, "Zum 'Proterodynamischen' Wurzelpräsens," in *Pratidānam: Studies Presented to F. B. J. Kuiper*, edited by J.

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summarily dismisses McCone's analysis, simply asserting that "Narten"-presents did not exist as a PIE inflectional type; Matasović does not, however, introduce any substantial morphological or phonological arguments to support his claim. Therefore, proceeding from the respective views of McCone and Matasović, I will here undertake the renewed consideration that *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* all demand. Ultimately, I find that the balance of evidence speaks against the interpretations offered in McCone (1991), but that the solutions given by Matasović are likewise unacceptable. Instead, I propose that each of the three Old Irish present stems under discussion has a must be evaluated individually; one cannot proceed from a single Indo-European inflectional type.

The structure of the paper is as follows: section II introduces the basis for and details of reconstruction for the PIE "Narten"-present; section III proceeds to outline the assumptions that McCone (1991) makes in his account of *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-*; sections IV-VI treat the etymology and inflectional history of *rig-*, *ith-*, and *ic*, in that order; section VII draws general conclusions and points to other possible evidence for acrostatic present inflection Old Irish.

II. The PIE Acrostatic Present *vis-à-vis* Other Root Presents

The LIV² (14ff.) posits four types of root presents, that is, present-stems in which the verbal root forms a present stem without any derivational suffixes:

- 1(a): "amphidynamisches Wurzelpräsens" or AMPHIKINETIC root present.
- 1(b): "akroodynamisches Wurzelpräsens" or ACROSTATIC root present.

Heesterman, G. Schokker, and V. Subramoniam (Den Haag: Mouton de Gruyter, 1968, pp. 9-19.

1(c): “nullstufiger Wurzelstativ” or STATIVE root present with zero grade of the root.

1(d): “vollstufiger Wurzelstativ” or STATIVE root present with full grade of the root.

1(a) has long been recognized as a basic type of present formation for PIE, being securely reconstructable on the basis of several word equations, with identical paradigmatic accent/ablaut alternations. Specifically, alternation between a strong stem with full grade of the root and a weak stem with zero grade of the root characterizes this type:

- 3.sg.pres.act.ind. **h₁és-ti* ‘is’ > Vedic *ásti*, OIr. *is*, Lat. *est* : 3.pl.pres.act.ind. **h₁s-énti* > Vedic *sánti*, OIr. *it*, Lat. *sunt*
- 3.sg.pres.act.ind. **g^{wh}én-ti* ‘beats, strikes; slays’ > Vedic *hánti*, Hitt. *kuenzi*, OIr. *gonaid* (thematized) : 3.pl.pres.act.ind. **g^{wh}n-énti* > Vedic *ghnánti*, Hitt. *kunanzi*, OIr. *gonait*

The reconstruction of 1(b), on the other hand, goes back to the Narten (1968) interpretation of Vedic and Avestan material as continuing a Proto-Indo-Iranian (PIIr.) inflectional type that exhibited lengthened grade of the root in its strong stem opposed to full grade of the root in its weak stem. Narten reconstructed the paradigm for the PIIr. present paradigm built to the root **stau-* ‘praise’ (< PIE **steu-*, cf. Grk. *στέυται*) as follows:

Present Indicative Active

- (PIE **stéu-mi*) **stámi*: AV+ *stáumi* [*stāumi*], OAv. *stāumī* (?)⁵

⁵ De Vaan concludes that the better reading for this form is a full grade *staomī*: Michiel De Vaan, “‘Narten’ Roots from the Avestan Point of View,” in *Per aspera ad asteriscos: Festschrift for Jens Elmegård*

- (PIE **stéu-si*) **stáuši*
- (PIE **stéu-ti*) **státi* : AV+ *stáuti* [*stāuti*], RV *staut*, *astaut* [*stāut*]
- (PIE **stéu-mes*) **stáumasi*
- (PIE **stéu-te*) **stáuṭha*
- (PIE **stéu-nti*) **stáuati*

Present Active Participle

- (PIE **stéu-nt-*) **stáuar*: OAv. *stauuat-*

Present Indicative Middle

- (PIE **stéu-oī*) **stáuai*
- (PIE **stéu-soī*) **stáuṣai*
- (PIE **stéu-oī*) **stáuai* (**stáutai*): RV *stavé*, YAv. *staotā*
- (PIE **stéu-mesd^hoī*) **stáumadhai*: YAv. *staomaide*
- (PIE **stéu-d^huoī*) **stáudhūai*
- (PIE **stéu-ntoi*) **stáuatai*

Subsequently, scholars sought evidence for this demonstrable Indo-Iranian pattern among other Indo-European languages; the reconstruction of the 1(b) type for PIE is now given for many scholars of Indo-European linguistics, for whom, in principle, a form in any daughter language may justifiably derive from an acrostatic present. Disagreement on the topic Watkins (1969),⁶ treating much of the same material as Narten (1968), wrote: “*Einige Forscher haben diese Formen [viz., root presents with acrostatic ablaut] dem Indogermanischen selbst zuweisen wollen, währen sie in Wirklichkeit unabhängige Neuerungen darstellen, die nicht mehr der*

Rasmussen, edited by Adam Hyllested (Innsbruck: Institut für Sprachwissenschaft, 2004), pp. 591-99.

⁶ Calvert Watkins, *Indo-European origins of the Celtic Verb: I. The Sigmatic Aorist* (Dublin: Dublin University Press, 1969), pp. 27-32.

indogermanischen Periode angehören." Similarly, Kortlandt (1999)⁷ has argued that the primary evidence in Indo-Iranian of the "Narten"-type inflection is precisely an Indo-Iranian innovation. Indeed, evidence of lengthened-grade strong stems across Indo-European language is rare—taking the LIV²'s listing of type 1(b) presents as representative,⁸ one finds an acrostatic present reconstructed on the following grounds:

- lengthened-grade strong stem with corresponding full-grade weak stem in Indo-Iranian.
- lengthened-grade strong stem in Balto-Slavic generalized through the entire present stem.⁹
- full-grade weak stem (mainly to *media tantum*) in Greek.

Assuming that LIV² type 1(d) existed in the PIE, having exclusively middle inflection with full grade of the root throughout, many Greek forms classified as 1(b) would fit morphologically equally well with 1(d).

On the whole, I believe that the relative rarity of complete paradigms with the presumed ablaut alternations of acrostatic root-presents presents should be borne in mind when dealing with the category.¹⁰ Nevertheless, for the purposes of this paper, I accept the

⁷ Frederik Kortlandt, *Accent and Ablaut in the Vedic Verb*, (1999), <http://www.kortlandt.nl/publications/art188a.pdf>.

⁸ See: LIV², pp. 711-2.

⁹ However, if a voiced stop followed the root vowel, thus giving the conditioning environment for Winter's Law, it becomes impossible to know whether whether the Slavic *ě* and/or Lithuanian *ė* continues a genuine PIE **ē*. For example, the root form in OLith. *bégmi* 'run' and ORuss. *běgu* 'run' is legitimately reconstructable as either **bég^w*- or **bég^w*-. Greek *φέβεται* 'flees' suggests that a full-grade middle of LIV² type 1(c) (like *κείται* 'lies') might be at hand.

¹⁰ Limitations of space and topical focus here preclude any larger-scale evaluation concerning the status of acrostatic presents in the proto-language.

general validity of the category for PIE, and at the least, the current state of research on acrostatic root-presents does not allow one to dismiss altogether the possibility of such proto-forms, as Matasović (2009) does s.v. **ank-o-*, **ed-o-*, and **rig-o-*.

III. *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* according to McCone (1991)

McCone (1991) presents substantial etymological, phonological, and analogical argumentation to advance the claim that the present stems *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* most easily arrive from PIE into Old Irish if one reconstructs their PIE presents as having acrostatic inflection. I give here the PIE reconstructions to which McCone (1991) arrives for each of the Old Irish presents under consideration, along with etymological comparanda that McCone assumes:

- 3.sg. *ic* 'reaches' : 3.pl. *ecat* << PIE **h₂énk-ti* : **h₂énk-nti* (cf. Hittite *hi(n)kzi* 'allots').
- 3.sg. *ithid* 'eats' : 3.pl. *ethait* << PIE **h₁éd-ti* : **h₁éd-nti* (cf. Ved. *átti* 'eats', Lat. *ēst* 'eats').
- 3.sg. *rigid* 'stretches; directs, rules' : 3.pl. **regait* << **h₁₂rég-ti* : **h₁₂rég-nti* (cf. Ved. *rāṣṭi* 'rules', Lat. *rēx* 'king').

As discussion below shall show, the etymology, and thus verbal root, on which McCone (1991) bases his reconstruction, is problematic in the cases of both *ic* and *rigid*; only for *ithid* is PIE **h₁ed-* a certainty. More generally, however, the derivation of *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* from proto-forms with "Narten"-inflection is not phonologically straightforward: were an Indo-European lengthened-grade **ē* preserved into Old Irish, it would have appeared as <*i*>, since the regular outcome of Indo-European **ē* is Old Irish /*ī*/, not /*i*/; no spelling <*i*>, though, is attested in any form of any of these three

verbs.¹¹ McCone must therefore appeal to the following three-step analogical process within Proto-Celtic in order to account for the vocalism found in the attested Old Irish forms:¹²

Ablaut alternations of both quality and quantity are simplified to alternations of quality only, based on the vocalism of the 3.sg.: thus, Proto-Celtic 3.sg. **rīx-ti* < **h₁₂rég-ti* : 3.pl. **reg-anti* < **h₁₂rég-nti* become 3.sg. **rīx-ti* : 3.pl. **rig-anti*.¹³

The Proto-Celtic 3.pl. desinences **-enti* and **-anti*, from PIE **-énti* and **-nti*, respectively, are replaced by **-onti*, from the PIE thematic ending **-o-nti*.

The thematic vowel alternation **e/o* spreads, beginning from the 3.pl., throughout the originally athematic paradigm, bringing with it the vocalism of the root found in the 3.pl., thereby giving a uniform root vocalism

¹¹ Cf. Pedersen, Holger. 1913. *Vergleichende Grammatik der keltischen Sprachen II* (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1909), p. 50; and Rudolf Thurneysen, *A Grammar of Old Irish*. Translated, revised, and enlarged by D. A. Binchy and Osborn Bergin (Dublin: Dublin Institute for Advanced Studies, 1946), p. 120.

¹² McCone, "O.Ir. -ic...", pp. 2-3, 10.

¹³ The original argument for such an adjustment in ablaut seems to go back to McCone, building upon the dictum of Watkins that "in every paradigm inherited from Indo-European which exhibited a functional alternation between full grade and zero grade, in other words, paradigmatic Ablaut, Celtic has universally generalized the zero-grade. There are no exceptions to this; we may take it as given." Cf. Kim McCone, *Towards a Relative Chronology Ancient and Medieval Celtic Sound Change*, Maynooth Studies in Celtic Linguistics 1 (Maynooth: Dept. of Old Irish, St. Patrick's College, 1986), pp. 226-7; and Calvert Watkins, *Indo-European origins of the Celtic Verb: I. The Sigmatic Aorist* (Dublin: Dublin University Press, 1962), p. 189.

throughout the present stem: Proto-Celtic 3.sg. **rīx-ti* becomes **rig-e-ti* under the influence of 3.pl. **rig-o-nti*.

This particular confluence of remodelings in the Proto-Celtic verb is not fully demonstrable for any other verb inherited into Old Irish, as far as I can discern. Steps 2 and 3 are certainly necessary to account for the thematization of PIE amphikinetic presents like OIr. *gonaid* < **g^{wh}én-ti*.¹⁴ Otherwise, Old Irish would not exhibit uniformity of stem-vocalism and characteristic lowering of vowels by the thematic vowel **o* throughout Thurneysen BI verbs. Step 1, on the other hand, is a decidedly rarer phenomenon, in part because the sound changes to which PIE vowels were subject in the course of development into Proto-Celtic only occasionally aligned with ablaut to produce paradigmatic ablaut variation in both quality and quantity. In effect, only roots or suffixes that contained a full grade **eh₁* alternating with zero grade **h₁*, or lengthened grade **ē* alternating with full grade **e*, would produce Proto-Celtic alternations of both quality and quantity: the former would give Proto-Celtic **ī* / **a*, and the latter would give Proto-Celtic **ī* / **e* (just as McCone (1991) supposes for inherited "Narten"-presents).¹⁵ Ablauting forms involving syllabic resonants (with or without root-final laryngeals) would have arrived with unhappy schwebeablaut patterns into Proto-Celtic, but the behavior of those patterns is not strictly relevant here, since it does not fit McCone's criterion of alternation in both quality and quantity.

Possible applications of the Step 1 ablaut simplification outside of the potential "Narten"-presents may be found in two places: *á*-preterites and BV presents; McCone adduces the preterite 3.sg. *gáid* : 3.pl. *gádatar* 'prayed, entreated' as an example in the former

¹⁴ Warren Cowgill, "The Etymology of Irish *guidid* and the Outcome of **g^{wh}* in Celtic," in *Lautgeschichte und Etymologie. Akten der VI. Fachtagung der Indogermanischen Gesellschaft, Wien 1978* (Wiesbaden: Reichert, 1980), p. 61.

¹⁵ For purposes here, I will hold that PIE **eī* > **ē* is not a Proto-Celtic sound change.

group,¹⁶ and the present 3.sg. *a-tbaill* : 3.pl. *a-tballat* 'dies' as an example in the latter group.¹⁷ At best, I find perhaps one other example of the Step 1 ablaut simplification for a BV present (3.sg. *ara-chrin* : 3.pl. *ara-chrinat* 'decays, withers'), and maybe one other credible instance among *á*-preterites (3.sg. *táich* : 3.pl. *táichatar* 'flees'). I give here McCone's account of *gáid* and *a-tbaill*.

3.sg. *gáid* : 3.pl. *gádatar* continues a PIE perfect, 3.sg. **g^{wh}e-g^{wh}ód-e* : 3.pl. *g^we-g^wd-ór*, though the OIr. stem must continue a more immediate preform **g^wód-*. In Proto-Celtic, the simplification of the cluster **-g^wd-* in the plural (weak) stem resulted in a plural stem **g^wéd-*, at great variance with the strong stem **g^we-g^wód-*. Thus, the 3.pl. was remade to **g^wód-*, following Step 1, which became the stem for the entire preterite. Similarly, *táich* : 3.pl. *táichatar* could continue PIE **te-tók^w-e* : **te-tk^w-ór* (cf. LIV² for the root), developing to a Proto-Celtic strong stem **te-tók^w-* : weak stem **tēk^w-*. For both *gáid* and *táich*, though, solid external evidence of an inherited reduplicated perfect is wanting,¹⁸ and in general, one should bear in mind that "the unreduplicated long *á*-preterite defies any straightforward morphophonemic

¹⁶ Kim McCone, "From Indo-European to Old Irish: Conservation and Innovation in the Verbal System," in *Proceedings of the Seventh International Congress of Celtic Studies*, edited by D. Ellis Evans, John G. Griffith, and E. M. Jope (Oxford: Cranham Press, 1986), pp. 236-7; and Kim McCone, *The Indo-European Origins of the Old Irish Nasal Presents, Subjunctives, and Futures* (Innsbruck: Innsbrucker Beiträge zur Sprachwissenschaft, 1991), pp. 2.

¹⁷ Kim McCone, "From Indo-European to Old Irish: Conservation and Innovation in the Verbal System," pp. 226-7; and Kim McCone, *The Indo-European Origins of the Old Irish Nasal Presents...*, pp. 12-13.

¹⁸ Gothic *bab* 'bade' (present *bidjan*) might also continue the perfect **g^{wh}e-g^{wh}ód*, but as long as the sound change **g^{wh} > Germanic b* remains uncertain, so too does the etymology.

derivation from a normal reduplicated prototype."¹⁹ Assuming that at some point in Proto-Celtic the weak stems **g^wéd-* and **tēk^w-* did exist, the reformation to **g^wód-* and **tōk^w-* strikes me as motivated by the replacement of an *e*-grade in the root, which would have been altogether aberrant in a perfect, with the more appropriate *o*-grade vocalism.

3.sg. *a-tbaill* : 3.pl. *a-tballat*, like all other BV verbs, continues a variety of nasal present, in this case, the ablauting infix **-né-* / **-n-*. Since Grk. βέλεμνα 'throw, shot' guarantees a root **g^welh₁-*, one may reconstruct 3.sg. **g^wl-né-h₁-ti* : 1.pl. **g^wl-n-h₁-més* : 3.pl. **g^wl-n-h₁-énti*, the Proto-Celtic outcome of which is **g^wal-nī-ti* : **g^wal-na-mes* : **g^wal-n-enti*. Following Step 1, the forms **g^wal-nī-ti* : **g^wal-ni-mes* : **g^wal-ni-nti* emerge, and following Step 3, then **g^wal-ni-ti* : **g^wal-ni-mes* : **g^wal-ni-nti*. The lack of palatalization in 3.pl *a-tballat* (instead of **a-tbaillat*) is difficult to explain on any phonological ground, but follows directly if one instead simply allows for the thematization of the stem from **g^wal-nī-ti* : **g^wal-ni-mes* : **g^wal-ni-nti* to **g^wal-n-e-ti* : **g^wal-n-o-mes* : **g^wal-n-o-nti*, thus obviating the need to move through the Step 1 ablaut modification.²⁰

¹⁹ Kim McCone, *The Early Irish Verb*, Maynooth Monographs No. 1 (Maynooth: An Sagart, 1987), p. 54.

²⁰ McCone protests that thematization could not have occurred in *a-tbaill*, because it did not occur in BIV presents like *cren* : *crenat* (< **k^wri-né-h₂-ti* : *k^wri-n-h₂-énti*). Sound change into Proto-Celtic created such different alternations in vocalism between the two types, though, that nasal presents to roots in **h₁* and roots in **h₂* or **h₃* must have diverged totally – they no longer constituted a class that needed share in common developments. Cf. McCone, *From Indo-European to Old-Irish...*, p. 12.

Yet sharper arguments against the Step 1 ablaut realignment exist. Firstly one might expect to find examples of the process inherited in the sigmatic aorists as well, as McCone admits,²¹ but whether the vocalism is *t*-preterites (continuing PIE *s*-aorists to *TeT*-roots) must go back to Proto-Celtic **i* (as Step 1 would predict) or **e* (as Watkins reconstructs)²² is very difficult to tell. More tellingly, two strong possible counterexamples to Step 1 exist: *sníid* 'twists' (DIL:S-302) and *líid* 'accuses, imputes to' (DIL:L-153), both class AIII verbs, continuing roots in a final laryngeal. Both forms have two possible reconstructions: 1) as traditional amphikinetic root presents, that took on weak inflection with a **-ie/o-* suffix, or 2) as *i*-presents with acrostatic inflection, as is Jasanoff's view.²³

- OIr. 3.sg. *sníid* : 3.pl. *sníit* is cognate with Grk. *νήν* (Aeolic 3.sg. impf. *ἔννῃ*) 'spin', Lat. *nēre* (2.sg. *nēs*) 'spin', OHG *nāen* 'sew', W *nyddu* 'twist', and possibly Latv. *snāju* (with falling tone *à*) 'weave; clear out. LIV²:572 sets up an amphikinetic root present on the basis of the Latin and Greek, thus 3.sg. **snéh₁-ti* : 3.pl. **snh₁-énti*. The PIE would become Proto-Celtic **snī-ti* : *san-enti*. Although the root ablaut variation was leveled at some point, the long vowel of the singular instead seems to have been carried through the paradigm. Jasanoff (2003) instead reconstructs a strong stem **snéh₂-i-* : weak stem **snéh₂-i-*, with **h₂* on the basis of the possible Latvian cognate, accepting Eichner's Law (i.e., non-coloration of PIE **ē* by laryngeals) to allow for *ē* (instead of *ā*) in Latin and *ā* (instead of *ō*) in OHG. **snéh₂-i-* : **snéh₂-i-* would produce Proto-Celtic **snī-* :

²¹ McCone, *From Indo-European to Old Irish...*, p. 231-2.

²² Watkins, *Indo European Origins of the Celtic Verb...*, p. 22.

²³ Jay Jasanoff, *Hittite and the Indo-European Verb* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2003), pp. 109-110.

**snāi-*. Again, leveling in favor of the strong stem must have taken place to give *sníid* : *sníit*.

- The length of the vocalism in *líid* 'accuses' is inconsistently written in the early Glosses: Wb. 2 a 13 reads *ni liim for suide* 'I do not make him responsible', for expected 1.sg.pres. **líim*. The Glosses, though, not infrequently fail to mark vowel length, so forms like *liim* are not an objection, and the later spelling *líid* must reflect the true vocalism. Just as with *sníid* above, an amphikinetic root present (to a root **leh₁-*) or an acrostatic *i*-present (to a root **leh₂-*), is a possible reconstruction, but again, in either case, the Proto-Celtic **ī*-vocalism must have won the day.

sníid and *líid* thus are counterexamples at least to McCone's Step 1 ablaut simplification, and perhaps to Watkins' principle that the vocalism of the weak stem always spread throughout the paradigm in Old Irish. Watkins' principle may be salvaged, however, if one makes one of two assumptions:

1. The Proto-Celtic **ī*-vocalism must have been extended to the weak stem prior to the more wide-scale generalization of weak stem vocalism throughout the paradigm of ablauting presents.
2. *sníid* and *líid* are indeed acrostatic presents, with or without *i*-extensions, but then must be to roots ending in **h₁*. If so, PIE **snéh₁(-i-)* : **snéh₁(-i-)* and **léh₁(-i-)* : **léh₁(-i-)* would produce Proto-Celtic *snī(i)-* : *snī(i)-* and *lī(i)-* : *lī(i)-*, without any paradigmatic ablaut.

In sum, that the process of strict ablaut simplification as described in Step 1 above took place in Proto-Celtic is difficult to prove. If *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* otherwise unproblematically continued PIE acrostatic presents, then one might accept the Step 1 principle, since it could help account for some *á*-preterites and BV presents as well. However, the succeeding sections shall argue that other accounts of

ic, *ith-*, and *rig-*, equal or superior to the reconstruction of acrostatic presents, are available.

IV. *rigid* 'stretches; directs, rules'

Simplex *rigid* (DIL:R-68) is attested with two primary senses 'stretches, distends' and 'directs, controls, subdues'. A third meaning, 'binds', is restricted to the *Laws* (v 152.16 and v 466.24), which must be the simplex corresponding to the prefixed form *conrig* 'bind together, ties, constrains' (DIL:C-458).²⁴ Formally similar and possibly related as well to *rigid* is *a-treig* 'rises', with an infix reflexive pronoun. Three PIE roots given in LIV² are formally suitable as the basis for *rigid*:

- **h₃reǵ-* 'stretches out, sets straight' (cf. LIV²:304), which Grk. *ὀρέγω* 'stretches', Lat. *regō* 'sets straight', Ved. 3.pl.mid. *rñjate* 'move in a straight line', and Goth. *rikan* 'accumulate' certainly continue.
- **reiǵ-* 'stretch, elongate' (cf. LIV:503), which underlies Lith. *reĩžti* 'tighten' and OE *ræcan* 'reach, lengthen'.
- **reiǵ-* 'bind' (cf. LIV:503), based on Lat. *rigēō* 'be stiff' and OHG *ricken* 'bind'.

Conrig and simplex *rigid* meaning 'bind' belong with Lat. *rigēō* and OHG *ricken*, for all of which one may unproblematically reconstruct a zero-grade thematic present **rig-e/o-*. Thus, *conrig* and its simplex have no significant role to play in accounting for *rigid* 'stretches; directs'.

Meanwhile, Matasović traces both *rigid* 'stretches; directs' and *a-treig* 'rises' back to forms built to PIE **h₃reǵ-*: *rigid* would

continue a zero-grade thematic present, **h₃reǵ-é/ó*, but *reig* would reflect a full-grade thematic present, **h₃réǵ - e/o-*.²⁵ Two significant objections preclude the set of reconstructions that Matasović proposes:

- Given that the phonological sequence **#HR-* (where *R* is any syllabic liquid) developed to OIr. *ar-*, as in OIr. *argat* 'silver, gold' (compare Lat. *argentum*, YAv. *ərəzata-*, Gaul. *aracanto*, MW *ariant*; cf. NIL:317ff.), **h₃reǵ-é/ó-* is not a possible reconstruction for *rigid*. Further examples of such vocalization with syllabic nasals exist: OIr. *ingen* 'nail' < PCelt. **angen* < **h₃ng^{wh}-* (cf. Lat. *unguis*) or *imb* 'around' < PCelt. **amb-* < **h₂mb^{hi}-* (cf. Gaul. *ambi*).
- Examples of full-grade and zero-grade thematic presents built to the same root are vanishingly rare: out of 426 possible full-grade thematic presents and 52 possible zero-grade thematic presents reported in LIV², only two roots (**spen_h1-* 'pull, stretch' and **ueiǵ-* 'distance oneself') appear to have built both the full-grade and the zero-grade thematic type. Therefore, that **h₃reǵ-* also belongs to that class is statistically unlikely.

Since *a-treig* 'rises' (perhaps literally 'stretches/extends oneself out') is formally identical to Grk. *ὀρέγω* 'stretches' and Lat. *regō* 'sets straight' (< **h₃réǵ-e/o-*), the phonological derivation is unproblematic, and the semantic match is reasonable, the reconstruction **h₃reǵ-e/o-* > OIr. *reig* is very likely correct. Further proof comes from a phrase in the Gaulish inscription from Chamalières, which reads *reguc cambion* 'I straighten the crooked', following Fortson 2011:314, in which *regu(c)* is exactly *ὀρέγω* and

²⁴ Daniel A. Binchy, *Corpus Iuris Hibernici* (Dublin Institute for Advanced Studies, 1978); Commissioners for Publishing the Ancient Laws and Institutes of Ireland, *Ancient Laws of Ireland* (Buffalo: W.S. Hein, 2000).

²⁵ Matasović, *Etymological Dictionary of Proto-Celtic*, pp. 308, 312.

regō.²⁶ Matasović's derivation of *rigid* 'stretches; directs' from **h₃rġ-é/ó-* is to be dismissed.

Hamp (1987:186) attempts a slightly different connection of *rigid* to **h₃reġ-*, via the Sanskrit Class IV present **fjyati*;²⁷ Hamp states: "We could easily have here... the exact equivalent of the Indic, with the expected zero-grade." However, I agree with the assessment of McCone that "3.sg.pass. *regair* and Mlr. 3.pl.rel. *regtai*... point clearly to an OIr. BI/SI present < [PCelt.] **rig-e/o-*;"²⁸ specifically, McCone means that the change of vowel from *i* before a palatal consonant to *e* before a non-palatal consonant is indicative of BI/SI inflection—compare 3.sg. *conrig* : 3.pl. *conregat* 'bind'.²⁹ Moreover, Hamp's derivation is subject to the same phonological objection as Matasović's, namely, that **h₃rġ-* would have yielded OIr. *arg-*, not *rig-*.

Both McCone (1991) and Matasović (2009) are altogether correct that the immediate preform to *rigid* must be **rig-e/o-*. However, the stages necessary to derive **rig-e/o-* from the acrostatic present **h_{1/2}rġ- : *h_{1/2}réġ-* or the zero-grade thematic present **h₃rġ-é/ó-* are untenable.³⁰ By elimination, only a connection with **reġ-*

²⁶ Fortson states: "The reason for the *-c* at the end of *reguc* is disputed." Cf. Benjamin Fortson IV, *Indo-European Language and Culture: an Introduction* (Malden, MA: Blackwell Textbooks in Linguistics, 2004), p. 314.

²⁷ One should note that the attestation of a present stem *fjya-* is very marginal, limited to three forms in the *Rgveda*: twice the pres.part.act. *fjyant-* and once a 3.sg.med. *fjyate*; the 3.sg.pres.act. form with which Hamp operates is not attested.

²⁸ McCone, "O.Ir. *-ic...*," p. 9.

²⁹ McCone, *The Early Irish Verb*, pp. 29–31. According to Schumacher, *regtai* is in fact the 3.pl. absolute form, but with a suffixed pronoun, which induced syncope of the second vowel; cf. Stefan Schumacher, *Die Keltischen Primärverben* (Innsbruck: Innsbrucker Beiträge zur Sprachwissenschaft, 2004), p. 543.

³⁰ McCone operates with a root **h_{1/2}reġ-* because he sees forms with lengthened grade pertaining to rulership, such as the nouns OIr. *rí* and

'stretch, elongate' remains. If **reġ-* originally formed an amphikinetic root present **reġ- / *rġ-*, then the extension of the zero-grade alternant throughout the paradigm and thematization typical to the prehistory of BI presents gives *rigid*. To explain how *rigid* also has the meaning 'directs, controls, subdues', two possibilities exist: either 'directs, controls, subdues' is a natural semantic extension of 'stretch', (just as the Ved. *rāṣṭi* 'rules' and Grk. *ῥέγω* 'stretches' indicate for the root **h₃reġ-*), or *rigid* has taken over the function of PCelt. **reg-e/o-* (seen in the *reguc* of Chamalières mentioned above).

V. *ith-* 'eats'

On a purely formal basis, 3.sg. *ithid* : 3.pl. *ethait* looks like a Proto-Celtic **(f)it-e-ti : *(f)it-o-nti*, in turn suggesting a PIE root **peīt-* or **h₁eīt* (though I know of no root **h₁eīt* elsewhere). However, the corresponding subjunctive and future stems, *-(d)es(s)-* (later also *-eth*) and *is(s)* (though sometimes with *f*-future forms instead in Middle and Modern Irish) must derive from the common PIE root for 'eat', **h₁ed-* (cf. DIL:I-326). The immediate solution of Matasović is to set up a PIE reduplicated present **h₁i-h₁éd-ti : *h₁i-h₁d-énti*; to follow this reconstruction forward shows that it cannot be the origin of *ithid : ethait*.³¹ Specifically, the 3.pl. would have given a PCelt stem **īd-*: compensatory lengthening from the coda laryngeal would have produced a long vowel in the plural, not a short vowel, as Matasović writes. With subsequent extension of the plural vocalism and thematization, the OIr. result would have been 3.sg. *ídid* : 3.pl. *ídait*. Matasović makes no mention of the problem in consonantism, except to attribute it to the general influence of PCelt.

Lat. *rēx*, and the acrostatic present in Ved. *rāṣṭi* 'rules', as distinct from the thematic presents with full grade, such as Lat. *regō*, Grk. *ῥέγω*. However, the Toch. B 1.sg. subjunctive *rāśām* 'will stretch out' links formally to Ved. *rāṣṭi*, but semantically to Grk. *ῥέγω*. Therefore, all of these forms belong to the root **h₃reġ-*; cf. McCone, "O.Ir. *-ic...*," p. 10.

³¹ Matasović, *Etymological Dictionary of Proto-Celtic*, p. 113.

**fitu-* 'food'. PCelt. **fitu-*, or a related form, undoubtedly plays a role in the explanation of *ithid*—no other obvious means to account for the root consonantism is available—but the precise manner and motivation for its influence is not apparent in Matasović's treatment.

Before discussing *ithid* itself in greater detail, I will argue that, *contra* LIV²:230, the root **h₁ed-* probably did not build an acrostatic present **h₁éd-* / **h₁éd-*. No Indo-European language presents a secure trace of the lengthened grade; a detailed treatment of the forms follows:

- Hittite 3.sg.pres. *ēdmi* : 3.pl. *adanzi* directly reflects an amphikinetic present **h₁éd-ti* : **h₁d-énti*. Any other reconstruction that requires this Hittite verb to have taken up amphikinetic inflection analogically is not maximally efficient.
- Ved. 3.sg. *áti* : 1.pl. *admási*, 2.pl. *atthá*, 3.pl. *adánti* is also better derived from an amphikinetic than an acrostatic root present. An account of the given forms from an original acrostatic present must assume both spread of the weak-stem vocalism into the singular, as well as the introduction of the amphikinetic 3.pl. ending *-ánti* to replace expected *-ati*. Such analogies would be unmotivated, since Vedic preserves acrostatic presents relatively well. Derivation from an original amphikinetic merely requires introduction of the full grade into the plural stem as a phonological repair: 1.pl. **h₁d-més* and 2.pl. **h₁d-té* would have given Ved. **dmási* and **thá* (compare *smási* and *sthá* to $\sqrt{as}$ 'be'). 2.pl. **thá* lacks overt phonological material from the verbal root, and **dmási* contains a dental plus nasal sequence in absolute anlaut, which is disfavored if not impossible in Vedic.³²

³² I know of only one such example, *tmán-* 'self'.

- Lith. *émi* and OCS *jasti* both exhibit long vocalism on account of Winter's Law, which lengthens vowels preceding an original voiced stop. McCone doubts the validity of the law,³³ but subsequent research has safely explained the significant counterexamples to the law.³⁴
- The alternation between long and short vocalism in Lat. *edō, ēs, ēst* : *edimus, ēstis, edunt* is explicable on the basis of Lachmann's Law,³⁵ once the full grade of the strong stem is introduced into the weak stem, probably to counter phonological problems similar to those encountered in the Vedic. The analogical explanation given by McCone only demonstrates that derivation from an acrostatic present requires unwarranted difficulties.³⁶
- Welsh 3.sg. *ys* can only reflect **h₁ed-ti*.

The combined picture here illustrates that a PIE present stem **h₁éd-* / **h₁éd-* requires significant and unmotivated analogical changes in most of its daughter languages. On the other hand, a stem **h₁éd-* / **h₁d-* never requires any change to the strong stem, other than the application of phonological laws that are necessary regardless. Amphikinetic **h₁éd-* / **h₁d-* is the maximally efficient reconstruction, and therefore, one has no solid justification for seeking evidence of an acrostatic root present in *ithid*.

³³ McCone, "O.Ir. -ic. . .," p. 6.

³⁴ See especially: Vladimir A. Dybo, "Balto-Slavic Accentology and Winter's Law," in *Studia Linguarum* 3 (2002), pp. 295-515; and Rick Derksen, "Balto-Slavic Etymological Studies and Winter's Law: A Concise Review of Dybo 2002," in *Tones and Theories: Proceedings of the International Workshop on Balto-Slavic Accentology, Zagreb, 1-3 July 2005*, edited by Mate Kapović and Ranko Matasović (Zagreb: Institut za hrvatski jezik i jezikoslovje, 2007).

³⁵ Cf. Michael Weiss, *Outline of the Historical and Comparative Grammar of Latin* (Ann Arbor: Beech Stave, 2009), pp. 175, 431.

³⁶ McCone, "O.Ir. -ic. . .," pp. 7-8.

To return to *ith-* itself, the only clear way of accounting for both the consonantism and vocalism of the root is by reference to its corresponding verbal noun, *ithe*. *ithe* is a feminine abstract noun, **pit-ieh₂-*, identical to OCS *pišta* 'food'; Ved. *pitú-* 'food', Av. *pitu-* 'food', Lith. *piētūs* 'lunch', and MW *yt* 'grain' all continue **pit-u-*. Already in 1913 Pedersen suggested that *ithid* was a denominative in **-ie/o-* built to the stem **it-* of the verbal noun: "...es liegt am nächsten, in *ithid* einen *-ī-* Stamm zu sehen; vgl. asl. [OCS] *pitati*, *pitěti* 'nähren'."³⁷ McCone is right to object, though, that a denominative stem **it-je/o-* should have developed other inflectional attributes of denominal verbs, such as an *a*-subjunctive or an *f*-future.³⁸ Noteworthy, though, is the fact that a healthy majority of verbs whose verbal noun is a feminine in *-e* (< **-ieh₂*) belong to the BI/S1 class, as the data in Thurneysen shows:³⁹

3.sg.pres.abs.	Gloss	Verbal Noun
cla(i)did	'digs'	cla(i)de
sla(i)did	'strikes'	sla(i)de
figid	'weaves'	fige
sligid	'fells'	slige
ithid	'eats'	ithe
rigid	'stretches out'	rige
for ding	'oppresses'	fortige
gu(i)did	'prays'	guide

³⁷ Pederson, *Vergleichende Grammatik...*, p. 559.

³⁸ McCone, "O.Ir. *-ic...*," pp. 4-5. As mentioned above, though, some traces of an *f*-future begin to appear in Middle and Modern Irish.

³⁹ Thurneysen, *A Grammar of Old Irish*, p. 449.

All the verbs in the chart but *for ding* and *guidid* are B1/S1 presents, and one immediately sees that the verbal stem is identical for both the pres.abs. and the verbal noun. Hence, if W ys must come from **h₁ed-ti*, then the assumption of a Proto-Insular Celtic 3.sg. **esset* 'eats' < PCelt. **ed-ti* seems reasonable. An OIr. **essid* : **essait*, however, would have been at odds with its verbal noun, and such a discrepancy would be unique. The reason why the stem of the absolute and the stem of the verbal noun are regularly identical is because the both are based on the old zero grade of the root. This pattern may have then enforced parallelism between the present stem and the verbal noun. Therefore, I suggest that when *ithe* came to be the verbal noun in the paradigm of Archaic Irish 'eat', the present stem took over its form from the verbal noun wholesale, without any intervening derivation.

VI. *ic* 'reaches'

To begin, the etymological connection between *ic* and Hitt. *hi(n)kzi* 'bestows, allots' offered by McCone cannot be sustained.⁴⁰ Since Kloekhorst (2008:268-71) has demonstrated that the original Old Hittite verbal stem is *haink-*, not *hi(n)k-*, thus implying a preform **h_{2/3}ei_hnk-*.⁴¹ **h_{2/3}ei_hnk-*, however, is not of an acceptable Indo-European root shape, so perhaps Hitt. *haink-* is not even Indo-European in origin. On the other hand, the semantic and morphological connection between Ved. 3.sg.perf.act. *ānámśa* 'has reached' and the OIr. pret. to *ic*, *ánaic* 'reached', both deriving from a perfect **h₂e-h₂nók-* : *h₂e-h₂nk-*, is unimpeachable.⁴² Therefore, the present stem *ic* must somehow emerge from the root **h₂nek-* as well.

⁴⁰ McCone, "O.Ir. *-ic...*," p. 2.

⁴¹ Alwin Kloekhorst, *Etymological Dictionary of the Hittite Inherited Lexicon* (Leiden: Brill, 2008), pp. 268-71.

⁴² For the precise details in the history of the Vedic see: Martin J. Kümmel, *Das Perfekt im Indoiranischen* (Wiesbaden: Reichert, 2000), p. 287.

A connection with Lat. *nanciō*, *-ere* 'acquire' opens the way to a solution. *nanciō* itself looks to be the thematization of a old nasal present with an *i*-extension, thus **h₂n-n-k-i-*.⁴³ If such a nasal present existed and was inherited into Latin, then Celtic may have inherited a similar formation. Beginning from PIE 3.sg.pres. **h₂n-né-k-ti* : 3.pl. **h₂n-n-k-énti*, PCelt. *annekti* : *annkenti* results; compare the developments of **#HR/N* discussed above. In due course, the weak stem **annk-* becomes the present stem, and *a* raises to *e* before nasal plus stop.⁴⁴ Schrijver 1993:41 further shows that PCelt. **eNK-* (where *K* = any velar) > **inK*.⁴⁵ McCone, however, argues that such raising occurred only if the velar was voiced, grouping this raising of *e* > *i* with the wider raising of **eND-* > **iND* (where *D* = any voiced stop).⁴⁶ From a phonetic point of view, the inclusion of the voiceless velar in this raising is nicer, given that a parallel raising process is known for both Latin⁴⁷ and Hittite.⁴⁸

⁴³ The *a*-vocalism in *nanciō* is the result of a rare Latin sound law: **CCCC* > *CaCCC*, where *C* is any consonant, regardless of whether that consonant was syllabic or non-syllabic in Indo-European; cf. Peter Schrijver *The Reflexes of the Proto-Indo-European Laryngeals in Latin* (Amsterdam: Rodopi, 1991), pp. 495-6; and De Vann, 'Narten' Roots from the Avestan Point of View," pp. 399-400.

⁴⁴ Cf. Peter Schrijver, "The Development of Primitive Irish **an* before Voiced Stop," in *Ériu* 42 (1991), pp. 13-25.

⁴⁵ Peter Schrijver, "On the Development of Vowels before Tautosyllabic Nasals in Primitive Irish," in *Ériu* 44 (1993), pp. 33-52.

⁴⁶ Kim McCone, "'Double Nasal' Presents in Celtic, Old Irish *léicid* 'leaves,'" in *Mír Curad: Studies in Honor of Calvert Watkins*, edited by Jay Jasanoff, H. Craig Melchert, and Lisi Oliver (Innsbruck: Beiträge zur Sprachwissenschaft, 1998), p. 469.

⁴⁷ Cf. Andrew Sihler, *New Comparative Grammar of Greek and Latin* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1995), p. 39.

⁴⁸ H. Craig Melchert, *Anatolian Historical Phonology* (Amsterdam: Rodopi, 1994), p. 139.

Schrijver recapitulates the same scenario described here.⁴⁹ In light of Schrijver's treatment of the relevant phonological sequences, the suggestion of Matasović that *ic* is a sandhī-variant of negated **nī anketi* > **inketi*,⁵⁰ is *ad hoc* and superfluous.

VII. Conclusions

Matasović (2009) is most likely correct that the present stems *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* are not Celtic continuants of acrostatic presents, in part because the extra-Celtic evidence for an acrostatic present to the appropriate IE root is lacking. Furthermore, as I argued in detail in Section III, at least one crucial analogical step that McCone needed to arrive to the OIr. forms from the Indo-European is doubtful. However, because the morphological preforms that Matasović proposes are unacceptable, this larger review was necessary.

The fact that the solutions for *ic*, *ith-*, and *rig-* are clearer without the involvement of acrostatic presents does not entail that Old Irish or Celtic generally preserved no traces of such old present formations. In particular, *sníid* and *líid* discussed above may well continue "Narten"-presents, and Nikolaev convincingly argues that the *i*-preterites *mídair* 'judged' (pres. *midithir*) and *ro'ír* 'granted' continue "Narten"-imperfects.⁵¹ Indo-European acrostatic presents are an elusive category, as discussion under Section II hopefully impressed, and strong joint evidence from daughter languages is often necessary to motivate the reconstruction of their particular instantiations.

For convenience, I offer an overview on the prehistory of *ic* 'reaches', *ith-* 'eats', and *rig-* 'stretches; directs':

⁴⁹ Peter Schrijver, "Vedic *grbhñāti*, *grbhāyati* and the Semantic of **ye-* Derivatives of Nasal Presents," in *Münchener Studien zur Sprachwissenschaft* 59 (1999), pp. 115-62.

⁵⁰ Matasović, *Etymological Dictionary of Proto-Celtic*, p. 37.

⁵¹ Alexander Nikolaev, "Old Irish *ro-ír* and other *i*-preterites" (paper presented at the 30th Annual Harvard Celtic Colloquium, October 8-10, 2010).

OIr. 3.sg.	OIr. 3.pl	PCelt.	PIE	Comments
<i>ic</i>	<i>ecat</i>	* <i>annk-</i>	Nasal Present: * <i>h₂n-né-k-</i> / * <i>h₂n-n-k-</i>	See further Schrijver 1999
<i>ithid</i>	<i>ethait</i>	* <i>eset</i> << * <i>essi</i> < * <i>editi</i>	Amphikinetic Present: * <i>h₁éd-</i> / * <i>h₁d-</i>	OIr. present stem taken from the verbal noun <i>ithe</i>
<i>rigid</i>	<i>regtai</i>	* <i>rig-e/o-</i>	Amphikinetic Present: * <i>réig-</i> / * <i>riḡ-</i>	<i>a-treig</i> 'rises' < * <i>h₃réḡ-e/o-</i> , cf. Grk. <i>ópeýw</i>

Bragmaticus omnibus brittonibus:
**David, Sulien, and an Ecclesiastical Dynasty in
 Conquest-Era Wales**

Sarah Zeiser

In the twelfth-century Life of Saint Padarn,¹ the saint has a close

¹ While the earliest manuscript that contains this Life dates from c.1200 (London, British Library Cotton MS Vespasian A.XIV), the Life itself has been dated to the decades surrounding the turn of the twelfth century. Arthur Wade-Evans dated the *Vita Sancti Paterni* to c.1120, "when it was being pretended that St. Teilo had been diocesan bishop of Morgannwg, as St. David of Rheinwg, and St. Padarn of Seisyllwg" (A.W. Wade-Evans, *Vitae Sanctorum Britanniae et Genealogiae* (Cardiff: University of Wales Press Board, 1944), xii-xiii). This argument has since been deemed unnecessary, given that Llandaff had become associated with Teilo since the 1030s (Wendy Davies, *An Early Welsh Microcosm: Studies in the Llandaff Charters* (London: Royal Historical Society, 1978), 21–2 and 155). The allowance for an earlier dating of the Life fit with the model suggested by David Howlett, that Ieuan ap Sulien wrote it in time for the visit of William the Conqueror to St. David's in 1081 (Charles Thomas and David Howlett, *'Vita Sancti Paterni': The Life of Saint Padarn and the Original 'Mini' Trivium* 33 (2003): 1-129, p. 76). Whether the Life was composed for this purpose specifically we are unable to determine, though there has been some criticism of Howlett's argument (cf. John Reuben Davies' criticism regarding the similar argument made for dating Rhygyfarch ap Sulien's *Vita Sancti David* to c.1081 (John Reuben Davies, "Some Observations on the 'Nero', 'Digby', and 'Vespasian' Recensions of *Vita S. David*," in *St David of Wales: Cult, Church and Nation*, eds. J. Wyn Evans and Jonathan M. Wooding (Woodbridge: The Boydell Press, 2007), 156–60). Dating the Life to pre-1100 suits the relative dating of the Old Welsh quatrain regarding the staff of Padarn (found in Cambridge, Corpus Christi College MS 199, f. 11r) as well as references made to the *hystoria* of Padarn in Rhygyfarch's Life of David (for further discussion, see: Paul Russell, "The *Englyn* to St Padarn Revisited," *Cambrian Medieval Celtic Studies* (2012, forthcoming). Some version of the *Vita Paterni* existed from the late-eleventh century (during the lifetime of suspected author Ieuan ap Sulien, whose death is recorded in *Brut y Tywysogion* in 1137), though we remain unable to determine if that text is what was recorded in the Vespasian MS in c.1200. The current